Nouns – Animate and Inanimate

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Lesson 2

In the Russian language, all nouns fall into two categories—animate and inanimate. The first unites human beings (including professions and places in society), animals, birds and fish. All of these words answer the question **кто это?** The second category includes objects which answer the question **что это?**

Animate

Кто это?	Who is it?
челове́к	a human
соба́ка	a dog
кот	a cat
ма́ма	mama
друг	a friend
брат	a brother
учи́тель	a teacher
дире́ктор	a director
студе́нт	a student
ме́неджер	a manager
лев	a lion
аку́ла	a shark

Inanimate

Что это?	What is it?
стол	a table
дом	a house
маши́на	a car
компью́тер	a computer
сок	juice
кни́га	a book
ла́мпа	a lamp
метро́	metro
биле́т	a ticket

Remember

Names of social groups, like **семья́**, **гру́ппа**, **кома́нда** are inanimate in Russian.

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